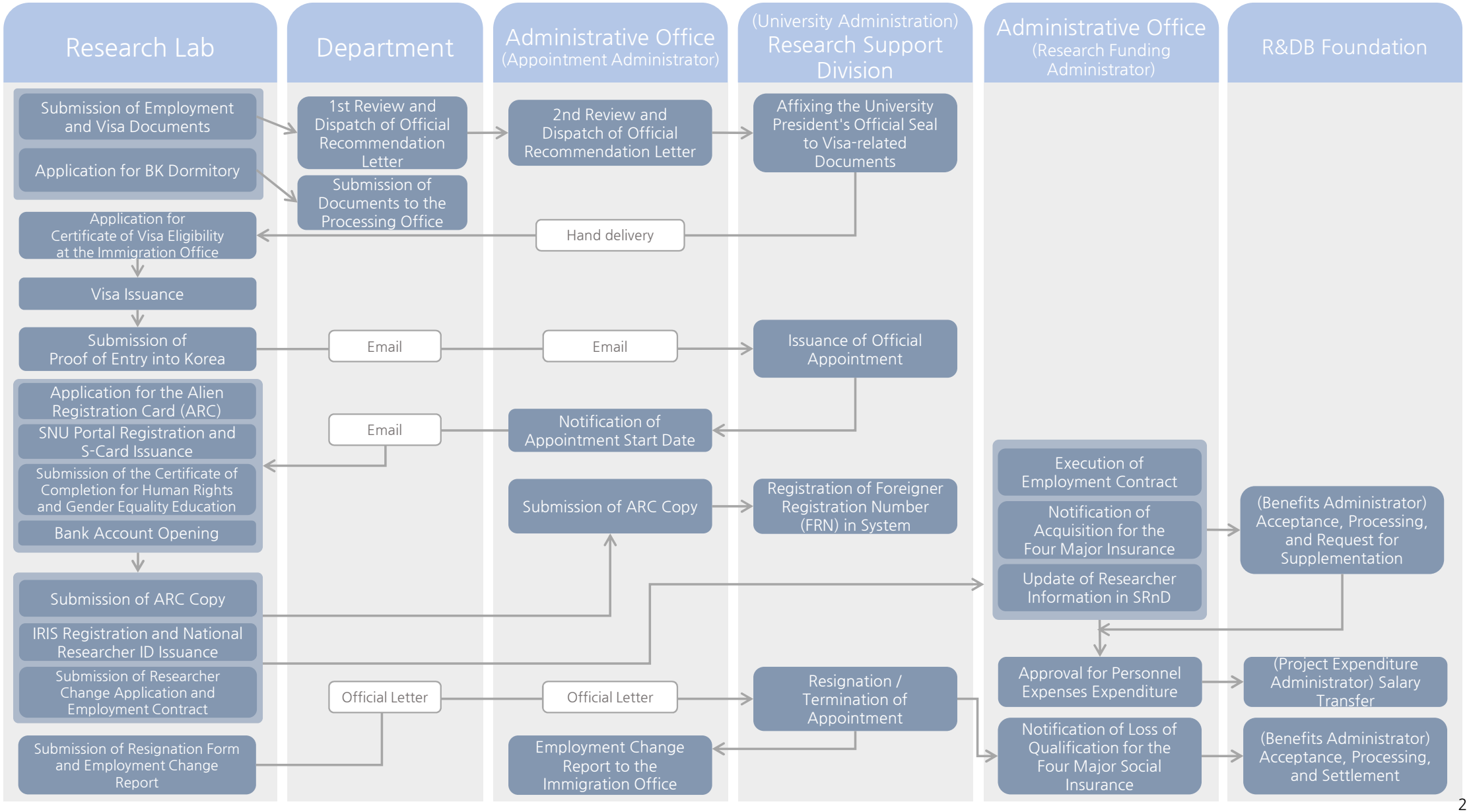
Guide for International Researchers at SNU

An A-Z Guide from Appointment to the End of Employment

SCIENCE
자 연 과 학 대 학 • 기 초 과 학 연 구 원

2026.01.08. v 1.0


Research Lab
Department
Administrative Office (Appointment Administrator)
(University Administration) Research Support Division
Administrative Office (Research Funding Administrator)
R&DB Foundation
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Submission of Documents to the Processing Office
2nd Review and Dispatch of Official Recommendation Letter
Affixing the University President's Official Seal to Visa-related Documents
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Email
Email
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Execution of Employment Contract
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(Benefits Administrator) Acceptance, Processing, and Request for Supplementation
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Submission of Researcher Change Application and Employment Contract
Official Letter
Official Letter
Resignation / Termination of Appointment
Approval for Personnel Expenses Expenditure
(Project Expenditure Administrator) Salary Transfer
Submission of Resignation Form and Employment Change Report
Employment Change Report to the Immigration Office
Notification of Loss of Qualification for the Four Major Social Insurance
(Benefits Administrator) Acceptance, Processing, and Settlement

[Submission Deadline] Between two months and one month prior to the desired appointment date

[Processing Time] Up to 2-3 weeks (department and administrative review, President's approval)

※Documents requiring an official seal must be collected in person by the research lab from the Division of Research Support, 5th Floor, Administration Building (Building 60).

	Required Documents	Notes
Employment	① Employment Recommendation of Researcher	College of Natural Sciences: Eligibility limited to Postdoctoral Researchers only Research Institute of Basic Sciences: All research ranks are eligible (Principal, Senior, Visiting, Postdoctoral, Researcher)*
	② Recognizance	
	③ Consent for the Collection and Use of Personal Information	
	④ Consent for Sex Offense Background Check	Required even for foreign nationals who have not yet entered Korea (Passport number must be provided in place of an Alien Registration Number)
	⑤ Curriculum Vitae (any standard format accepted)	
	⑥ Certificate of Final Degree	
	⑦ Copy of Passport	
	⑧ Certificate of Employment / Professional Experience (Principal, Senior, and Visiting Researchers only)	If Master's or Doctoral study is recognized as professional experience, official transcripts for the entire period are required to verify completed semesters.
	⑨ Agreement of Dual-Job Form (Visiting Researchers only; must bear the official seal of the head of the home institution), and Certificate of Employment from the home institution	
Visa	① Application for Certificate of Visa Eligibility	A separate application and power of attorney are required for each applicant and accompanying family member.
	② Proof** of Family Relationship (if accompanied by family members), Copies of family members' passports must be submitted	**Marriage certificates, birth certificates, or equivalent official documents may be submitted in place of a family relationship certificate
	③ Power of Attorney	The authorized representative for visa application procedures at the Immigration Office must be a Seoul National University employee eligible to obtain a certificate of employment; students are not eligible.

*Research Assistants appointed by the Director of the Research Institute of Basic Sciences are eligible for appointment only if they already hold an E-3 visa (issuance of a Confirmation of Visa Issuance and a Power of Attorney is not available).

[Important Notes]

- All documents must list the applicant's name in English in the order of **Family Name - Given Name - Middle Name(s), as shown in the name order shown in the machine-readable zone (MRZ) of the passport.**
- Failure to follow this name order may result in errors during IRIS registration, mobile phone activation, and identity verification procedures. Please ensure accuracy.

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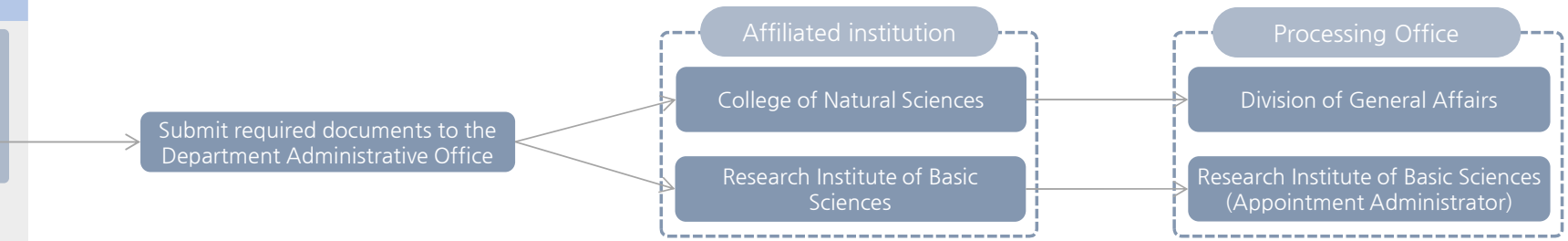
Submission of ARC Copy

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[Processing Office] Depends on the foreign researcher's affiliated institution.



[Required Documents]

	Single Occupancy	Family Accompanied (Additional Documents Required)	Notes
Required Documents	① Copy of Passport	③ Copy of Each Family Member's Passport (1 copy each)	· If applying for occupancy with a spouse, applicants must select the preferred room type between Building A (Family Unit) and Building B (Studio) · If applying for occupancy with children, only Building A is available.
	② Confirmation of Expected Employment	④ Proof of Family Relationship (e.g., Marriage Certificate, Child's Birth Certificate)	

[Contact Information] Gwanak Residence Halls Administrative Office ☎ +82-2-881-9038

Please refer to the Gwanak Student Residence application guide for move-in information.

For inquiries about room availability, eligibility, or room assignments, please contact the Residence Halls Administrative Office.

※ No pets are allowed.

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[Person in Charge] Authorized representative for the Application for Certificate of Visa Eligibility

[Processing Time] Varies depending on the applicant's nationality, visa type, and time of application.

The Immigration Office may require additional or different documents during the review process. As requirements and processing times may vary by case officer, applicants are advised to contact the office listed below in advance before visiting

[Important Notes]

Visiting Researchers: D-2-5 (Research study) visa, Other Researchers: E-3 (Research) visa

For all other visa types, applicants must contact the appointment administrator in advance.

[E-3 (Research) Visa Eligibility and Required Documents]

Please contact the Immigration Office in advance if you need to retrieve any submitted documents.

Eligibility Requirements
① Holders of a doctoral degree (including those expected to receive the degree)
② Holders of a master's degree with at least three years of relevant professional experience

※ Exemptions from the master's degree experience requirement

Exemption Criteria	Details
Holders of a Korean master's degree	Individuals who have completed a master's program at a university in Korea.
Holders of a master's degree from top-ranked universities	① Universities ranked within the top 200 worldwide by Times Higher Education (THE), or ② Universities ranked within the top 500 worldwide by QS World University Rankings
Authors of outstanding academic publications	Authors of articles indexed in SCIE, A&HCI, SCI, or SSCI *Including first authors, co-authors (second author or later), and corresponding authors.

Required Documents
① Application for Certificate of Visa Eligibility, passport, and one standard-sized photograph
② Business Registration Certificate (Seoul National University)
③ Certificate of a master's degree or higher, and certificate of career experience (if applicable)
④ Employment contract or Confirmation of Expected Employment
⑤ (If applying through a proxy) Power of attorney, the proxy's certificate of employment, and the proxy's identification
⑥ (If applicable) Certificate of (Expected) Graduation or other official documents issued by the university authorities indicating the degree conferral date
⑦ (If applicable) Supporting documents verifying authorship of outstanding academic publications

[Contact] HiKorea, the Korean Immigration Service website (https://www.hikorea.go.kr/Main.pt) or ☎ 1345 (within Korea)

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[Visa Application Process]

A proxy receives the Confirmation of Visa Issuance from the Immigration Office → forwards it to the foreign researcher → the researcher applies for a visa at a Korean diplomatic mission (e.g., an embassy or consulate) in their country of residence.

Additional required documents for an F-3 visa for accompanying family members vary by diplomatic mission.

Applicants should confirm the requirements with the relevant Korean diplomatic mission in advance.

[Submission of Proof of Entry into Korea]

After entering Korea, submit proof of entry (a copy of the passport page bearing the entry stamp or an Entry Confirmation document).

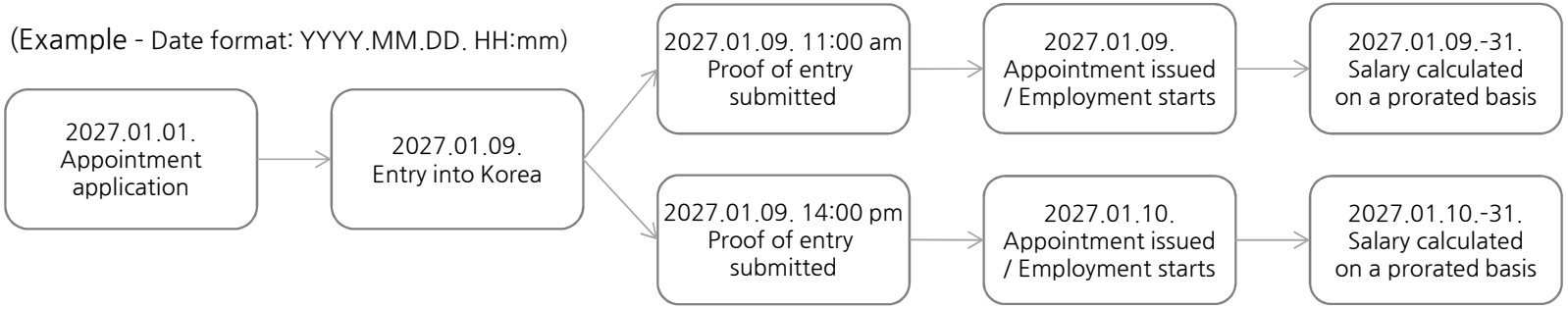
[Important Notes]

If the appointee does not enter Korea by the scheduled appointment date, the appointment will be deferred.

The appointment start date is determined based on when proof of entry is submitted.
If submitted before 12:00 pm, the appointment start date is the same day; if submitted after 12:00 pm, the appointment start date is the following day.

The appointment start date = the employment start date = the reference date for salary calculation.

(Example - Date format: YYYY.MM.DD. HH:mm)



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[Responsible Party] Foreign researcher (applicant)

[Processing Time]

- Alien Registration Number: approximately 2-3 days - Alien Registration Card (ARC): approximately 2 weeks to 1 month

Actual processing times may vary depending on the applicant's nationality, visa type, and time of application.

(For inquiries, please contact ☎1345)

※E-3 visa holders may apply without an appointment at the immigration office's Global Talents counter.
Accompanying family members (F-3 visa holders) may also apply at the same counter, provided they apply together on the same day.

[Required Documents]

The following documents apply to E-3 visa holders.For other visa types, please refer to the Ministry of Justice guidelines*.

* https://www.hikorea.go.kr/board/BoardNtcDetailR.pt?BBS_SEQ=1&BBS_GB_CD=BS10&NTCCTT_SEQ=1062&page=1

① Application form (Form No. 34)

② Passport (original and copy)

③ Color photograph (3.5 cm × 4.5 cm)

④ Application fee: KRW 30,000

⑤ Business Registration Certificate (Seoul National University)

⑥ Proof of residence

※ Residents of BK Residence Halls may obtain a Residence Confirmation Certificate via: mySNU Portal (my.snu.ac.kr) → Welfare → BK Residence Halls → Basic Information of a Residence → Residence Confirmation Certificate (print)
(If printing is unavailable, please contact the BK Residence Halls Administrative Office (T. 881-9038)to request residence approval.)

[Immigration Office Location]

Seoul Immigration Office (151 Mokdongdong-ro, Yangcheon-gu, Seoul, 서울시 양천구 목동동로 151)

- Subway Line 5 (Omokgyo Station, 오목교역, Exit 7) → Bus (6624, 6640B) → Get off at the Mokdong Middle School / Seoul Immigration Office bus stop (2 stops, about 3 minutes)
- Subway Line 5 (Omokgyo Station, 오목교역, Exit 7) → Walk toward Yangcheon District Office (양천구청) and Mokdong Middle School (목동중학교) (about 850 m, 15 min)

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[SNU Portal Registration] Contact Information: Seoul National University IT Service Center (ITSC) ☎ 02-880-8282

Portal Registration: Sign up at https://my.snu.ac.kr after completing identity verification using the email address listed on your appointment recommendation form.

After creating your account, please complete the SNU Online Education for Human Rights and Gender Equality (SNU Human Rights Center: https://helplms.snu.ac.kr/).

Please submit the certificate of education to your appointment administrator by email.

[S-Card Application]

Please refer to the website (https://student.snu.ac.kr/index.php?hCode=SCARD_05_01) for information on S-Card application.

[Bank Account Opening] Contact Information: Please refer to the on-campus bank contact numbers below.

A domestic Korean bank account is required to participate in research projects and receive salary payments.

Required documents vary by bank. Please contact the relevant bank in advance before visiting.

※ As of November 3, 2025, Woori Bank allows account opening without a physical Alien Registration Card.
A Certificate of Alien Registration is accepted instead. You must contact the bank in advance, as additional documents may be required.

[On-Campus Bank Locations]

Bank	Location	Phone Number	Bank	Location	Phone Number
NH Nonghyup	Building 109 (Jahayeon Cafeteria)	880-1934	Shinhan	Building 63 Student Center	871-7411
Woori	Building 4 Shinyang Hall II	887-7640	KB Kookmin	Building 101 Asia Center	889-9180

※ As of November 3, 2025, S-Cards can be issued only through Woori Bank.

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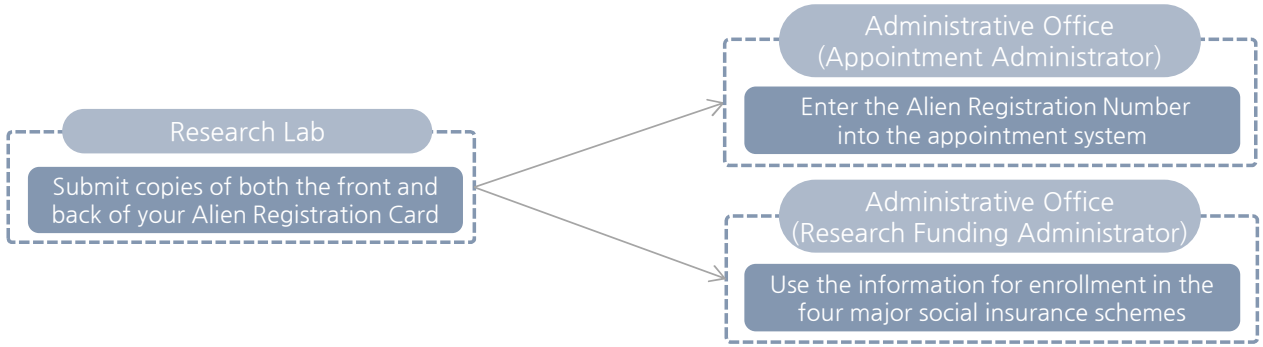
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[Submission of Alien Registration Card]



[IRIS Registration and National Researcher Number Issuance]

Registration with IRIS and issuance of an 8-digit National Researcher Number are mandatory for participation in national R&D projects.

Register as a member on IRIS (www.iris.go.kr) → Obtain an 8-digit National Researcher Number

If your Alien Registration Card has not yet been issued, select "Apply for registration as a foreigners without residence permit." (Administrator approval required; processing may take 1-5 days.)

※ Please refer to the IRIS membership registration and NRI researcher conversion manual.

[Note] Mobile Phone Activation in Korea

Mobile phone service can be activated using only a passport. However, **activation after issuance of a physical Alien Registration Card is recommended** for long-term use.

Salary payments are possible even without a Korean mobile phone number. However, in Korea, **domestic mobile phone number is required in most situations for identity verification**.

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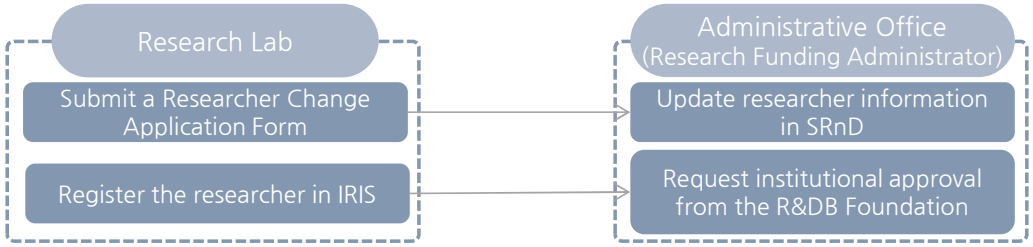
Submission of Letter of Resignation and Employment Change Report (For leaving)

[Employment Contract]

※ Submission deadline: The 10th day of the month following the start date of employment.
(Any administrative fines resulting from late submission will be the responsibility of the research lab.)

Position	Employment Contract	Four Major Social Insurance Schemes	Personnel Expenses	Notes
Visiting Researcher	Not applicable	Not applicable	Not applicable	Research allowances (classified as other income) can be paid for participation in research projects.
Principal / Senior / Postdoctoral / Researcher	Required	Required	Required (paid as earned income)	Personnel expenses and research allowances cannot be paid as other income.

[IRIS and SRnD Researcher Information Update]



[Enrollment in the Four Major Social Insurance Schemes]

Notes	Required Documents	
	Applicant	For National Health Insurance dependent registration
Coverage and processing timelines may vary depending on visa type, nationality, and the relevant insurance agency.	Employment contract	- Spouse's marriage certificate - Child's birth certificate
	Copy of passport and Alien Registration Card*	Copies of the dependent's passport and Alien Registration Card

*As of November 3, 2025, enrollment in the National Pension and Employment Injury Insurance is possible using a Certificate of Alien Registration.
For National Health Insurance, verification of the period of stay on the back of the Alien Registration Card is required.
Therefore, a copy of the physical card must be submitted.

[Foreign Researcher]
Obtain a National Researcher Number

[Research Lab]
Register the researcher in IRIS

[Administrative Office (Research Funding Administrator)]
Update researcher information in SRnD

[R&DB Foundation]
Complete social insurance enrollment procedures.

Final personnel expense payment in SRnD can be processed only after all of the above procedures have been completed in each system.

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[Reporting Obligations for Changes Involving Foreign Researchers]

In accordance with Article 19(1) of the Immigration Control Act, any major changes involving a foreign researcher (e.g., termination of employment, death, or disappearance) must be reported to the competent Immigration Office within 15 days.

- Exceptions:
  ① Visiting Researchers (not subject to an employment contract)
  ② Termination of employment for the purpose of transferring affiliation to another institution within Seoul National University

[Required Documents]

※ Submission deadline: One week prior to the resignation date or contract expiration date. (Any administrative fines resulting from late submission will be the responsibility of the research lab.)

Common	Reason for Separation		Important Notes
	Voluntary resignation	Contract expiration	
Notification of Changes in Employment/Training Status of Foreign Nationals (Immigration Control Act Enforcement Rules, Appendix Form No. 32)	**Letter of Resignation**	**Copy of employment contract**	- When submitting the documents, the relevant administrative office in charge of appointments and research funding must be notified of any domestic job change, internal transfer within Seoul National University, or whether the individual will return to their home country.

[Important Notes]

- Reporting is required even if employment ends due to the expiration of the appointment (contract) period.
- If the whereabouts of a foreign researcher become unknown, the matter must be reported within 15 days from the date the situation becomes known.
- If reporting is delayed due to retroactive termination of employment, any administrative fines incurred will be the responsibility of the research lab.

Reference Forms and Manuals

1. Forms and Guidelines for Researcher Appointment and Engagement
2. Forms for Application for Certificate of Visa Eligibility and Power of Attorney
3. Guidelines for Entering English Names Based on Passport
4. Announcement for Residency Application at SNU BK Residence Halls
5. Ministry of Justice Guide on Visa and Stay by Status (Visa Navigator: Customized Stay Guide) ※ Provided in Korean only
6. Manual for IRIS Registration and NRI Researcher Conversion (National Researcher Number Issuance)
7. Forms for Letter of Resignation and Employment Change Reporting